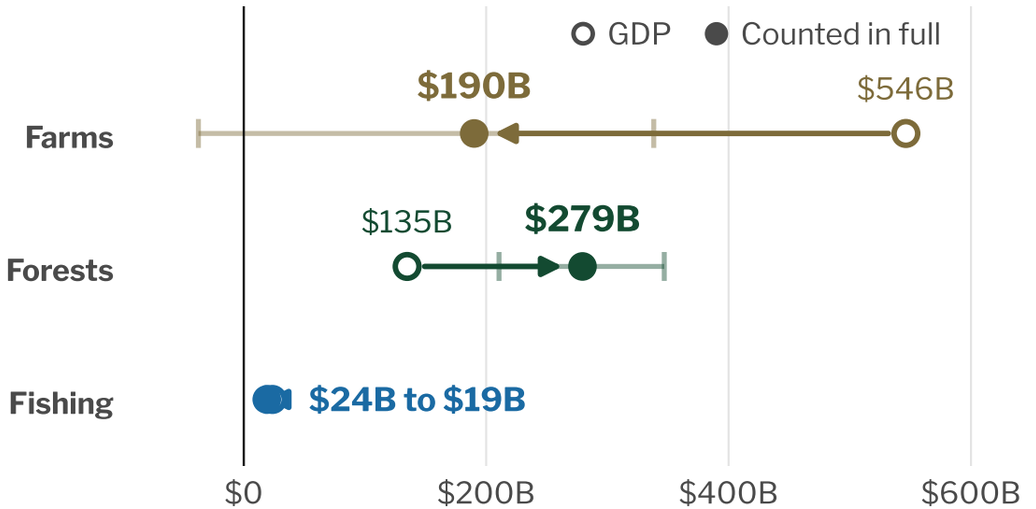
Of farms, forests and fishing, only forests give back more than GDP counts

Forests give about twice their GDP

2022, billions of dollars

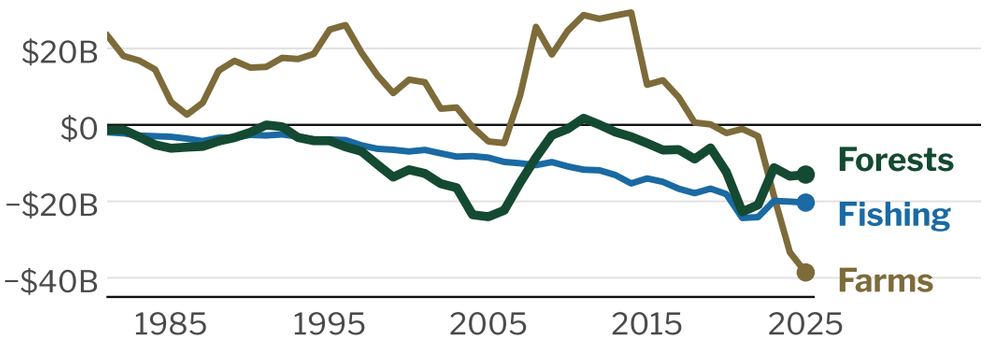


The U.S. buys more wood than it sells

Exports minus imports, billions of dollars a year

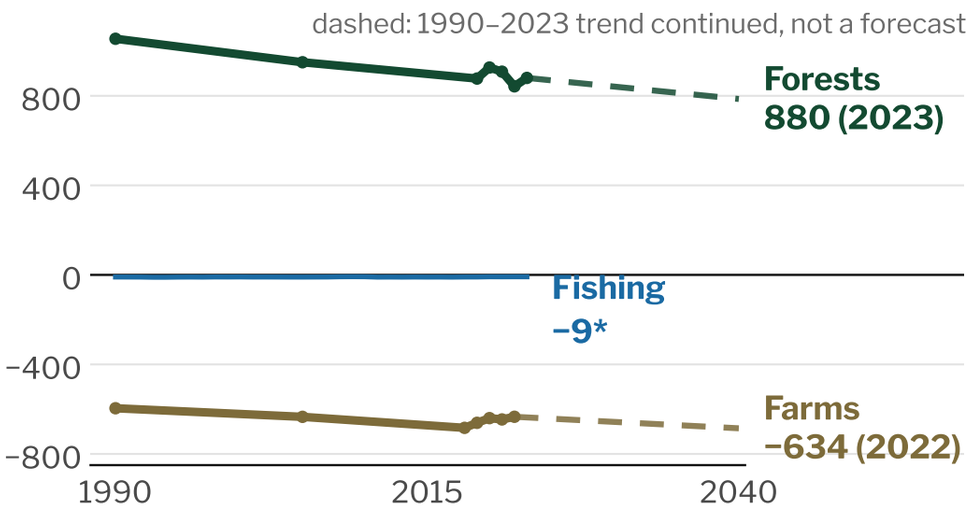
Wood: a deficit in 43 of 45 years

Cutting less wood in one place shifts harvest elsewhere, though the carbon effect can be much smaller (Daigneault et al. 2025)



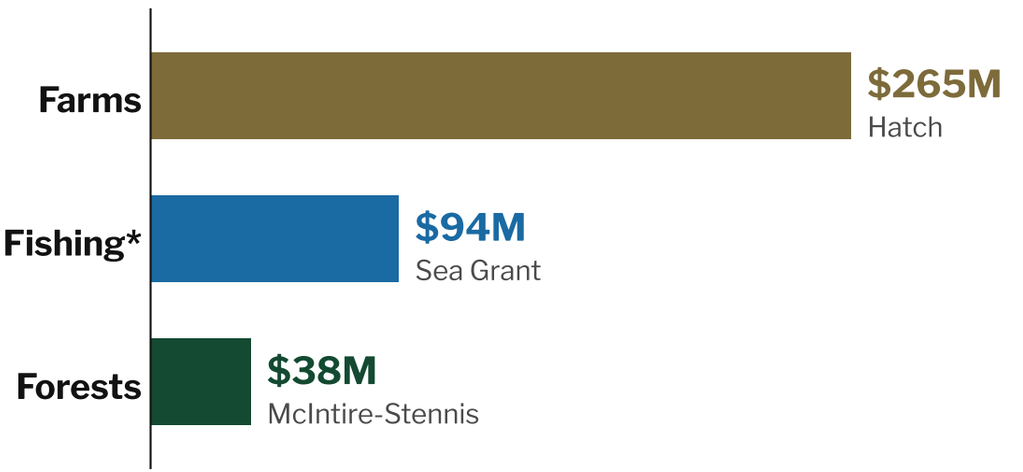
Only forests store more than they release

Million metric tons CO_2e a year, stored (+) or released (−)



Forests get a seventh of farm funds

University research funds, 2024



Each sector includes its processing (food, wood and paper, seafood). Counted in full: GDP less wear and tear, plus carbon at $120 a ton (bars: $51 to $190) and nature's other costs and benefits. Clean air value covers all U.S. trees. Carbon from EPA; dots mark reported years. *Fishing is estimated from landings; Sea Grant also funds coastal work. Trade: UN Comtrade, nominal dollars.

Data and methods: doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23122535. Weiskittel, Daigneault and Woodall, University of Maine.